

Greta the Goose's Soft Honk

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Greta was a big white goose. She lived by the reedy lake. Greta had a very loud honk. HONK HONK HONK! She honked at sunrise. She honked at her friends. She honked when she was happy. Her honk was the loudest on the lake. One afternoon, Greta honked hello to her friend Wren the water vole. HONK! Wren jumped a mile. She dropped her berry basket. Berries rolled everywhere. "Oh!" cried Wren. "That scared me!" Greta felt terrible. Her neck drooped. "I did not mean to frighten you," she said. She felt sad. Her loud honk kept startling her friends.



Wren was not angry. She picked up her berries. "Greta," she said kindly. "Your honk is wonderful." "But could you try a softer one?" "Just for close-up hellos?" Greta nodded. She wanted to try. Wren smiled. "Then remember this," she said. "A soft honk is a hug in sound." "A soft honk is a hug in sound." Greta repeated it softly. "A soft honk is a hug in sound." It became her gentle reminder. "A soft honk is a hug in sound."



Greta practiced by the reeds. First, her big honk. HONK! Too loud. Then a medium honk. Honk. Better. Then a tiny, soft honk. honk. It sounded like a whisper. Like a hug in sound. Greta felt excited. She felt hopeful. She practiced all afternoon. Honk... honk... honk. Soft as a feather. Wren clapped her paws. "Perfect!" she cheered. Greta beamed. She had a new honk.



Can you honk like Greta? First loud: HONK! Now medium: Honk. Now soft, like a hug: honk. Greta swam around the lake. She greeted everyone softly. honk, said Greta to the ducks. honk, said Greta to the frogs. Nobody jumped. Nobody dropped anything. Everyone smiled. "What a sweet honk!" they said. Greta felt proud. She felt gentle. Her soft honk made friends happy.



When the sun set, the lake turned pink. Greta tucked her beak under her wing. Wren curled in the reeds nearby. "Goodnight, soft honker," whispered Wren. "honk," yawned Greta, very softly. It was the gentlest goodnight. The water lapped quietly. The stars reflected on the lake. And Greta slept, soft and sound.

***Moral:** A gentle voice can be the warmest hello.*

The End